

## **France Lerner**

France Lerner is an interdisciplinary artist and researcher working at the intersection of neuroaesthetics, consciousness studies, and immersive technologies. She received her PhD in Art and Science from the Royal Academy of Arts and the Université de Liège, in collaboration with the Coma Science Group under the supervision of Prof. Steven Laureys.

Following postdoctoral research at the Weizmann Institute of Science in the Laboratory for Robotics and Virtual Reality, she held the position of Assistant Professor at the Beijing Institute of Mathematical Sciences and Applications (BIMSA). She is currently Research Fellow at the University of Haifa in the laboratory of Aviva Berkovitch-Ohana.

Her work investigates the spatial and perceptual organization of Near-Death Experiences (NDEs), with particular attention to self-location, motion, and mental imagery. It focuses on the sequencing of experience as a method to reconstruct its spatio-temporal chronology, and to identify the parameters that organize this sequencing. This approach makes it possible to determine the principal components of the experience, as well as those that are most salient within a given experiential sequence.

Within this framework of visual phenomenology, she develops experimental and visual methodologies that combine participant-generated drawings, neurophenomenological analysis, and generative AI to reconstruct and analyze subjective experiences across clinical and altered states of consciousness.